



Wildfires

Long periods of hot or dry weather can make plants dry out so much that they catch fire easily when struck by lightning. This can lead to a raging wildfire that burns down whole forests.

Stormy weather

Lightning strikes when electricity builds up in clouds. The electricity is created when ice crystals in the clouds rub against each other. A bolt of lightning heats the air around it so quickly that the air explodes, creating the rumbling noise we call thunder.

The brightest bolts of lightning travel upwards from the ground to the clouds.

Winds on the move

Wind is moving air. Warm air rises and cool air sinks. This movement is what makes the wind blow.



Twisters

Tornadoes (twisters) are whirling funnels of wind that form beneath massive thunderclouds. The fierce wind can do enormous damage, and the funnel can suck up debris like a gigantic vacuum cleaner.

weird or what?

In certain conditions hailstones can grow to be enormous. The biggest ever hailstone weighed 1 kg (2 lb) and was over 40 cm (16 in) across!